

UPSTRIDE RESOURCES

FREE PRACTICAL DIGITAL GROWTH SERIES

E-Commerce Playbook

Build a coordinated path from product discovery to repeat purchase.

A channel-ready operating guide for stores, marketplaces, fulfillment, conversion, and retention.

STRATEGY > SYSTEM > SCALE

YOUR NEXT STEP FORWARD

How to use this playbook

A channel-ready operating guide for stores, marketplaces, fulfillment, conversion, and retention.

**READ**

Understand the operating model.

**ASSESS**

Score your current state honestly.

**BUILD**

Complete one focused pilot.

**REVIEW**

Use evidence to improve the system.

A note on responsible use

This free publication is for educational and planning purposes. Adapt every recommendation to your business, customers, contracts, privacy obligations, security requirements, and local laws. It is not legal, financial, accounting, cybersecurity, or regulatory advice. Product and platform capabilities change; verify current requirements before implementation.



BASELINE

Where are you now?

Rate each statement from 1 (not true yet) to 5 (consistently true). Use the lowest scores to choose your first improvement.

01 We have a shared definition of success for offer.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

02 The current workflow and ownership are documented and understood.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

03 Our tools and data have clear sources of truth.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

04 Important exceptions are identified and assigned to a person.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

05 We measure outcomes, quality, and adoption - not only activity.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

06 The team reviews and improves the system on a regular cadence.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

YOUR BASELINE SCORE

6-14 START | 15-23 STABILIZE | 24-30 SCALE



THE UPSTRIDE FRAMEWORK

Five moves that build momentum

Use this sequence to move from a scattered effort to a visible, repeatable system.

01

OFFER

Set the direction and desired outcome.

02

STORE

Remove ambiguity and unnecessary friction.

03

TRAFFIC

Create the core workflow and supporting assets.

04

FULFILL

Launch with ownership, controls, and visibility.

05

RETAIN

Learn from evidence and strengthen the system.

OFFER IN PRACTICE

Shape a clear offer

Customers should understand the product, value, proof, and next action within seconds.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Define the primary buyer and buying occasion

Define the primary buyer and buying occasion.

2

Create a focused hero offer and bundles

Create a focused hero offer and bundles.

3

Answer objections with credible product details

Answer objections with credible product details.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

STORE IN PRACTICE

Design the buying journey

Reduce uncertainty across navigation, product pages, cart, checkout, and support.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Use consistent product information everywhere

Use consistent product information everywhere.

2

Make delivery, returns, and payment visible

Make delivery, returns, and payment visible.

3

Design mobile-first product discovery

Design mobile-first product discovery.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

TRAFFIC IN PRACTICE

Coordinate sales channels

Shopify, WooCommerce, Shopee, Lazada, and TikTok Shop need shared operating rules.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Choose a source of truth for inventory

Choose a source of truth for inventory.

2

Standardize naming, SKUs, and pricing logic

Standardize naming, SKUs, and pricing logic.

3

Assign owners for channel exceptions

Assign owners for channel exceptions.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

FULFILL IN PRACTICE

Operate fulfillment

Growth becomes fragile when stock, dispatch, and service cannot keep the promise.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Set cutoffs and service-level targets

Set cutoffs and service-level targets.

2

Automate status updates where possible

Automate status updates where possible.

3

Create playbooks for delays and returns

Create playbooks for delays and returns.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

RETAIN IN PRACTICE

Grow repeat revenue

Retention begins with a good first order and continues through useful communication.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Build post-purchase and replenishment flows

Build post-purchase and replenishment flows.

2

Segment by behavior, not only demographics

Segment by behavior, not only demographics.

3

Measure contribution after discounts and fees

Measure contribution after discounts and fees.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

MOVE FROM IDEA TO PILOT

A focused implementation sprint

Keep the first implementation narrow enough to learn quickly and important enough to matter.

1

Audit offer and product data

DAYS 1-3

2

Fix the mobile product journey

DAYS 4-7

3

Align inventory across channels

DAYS 8-11

4

Document fulfillment exceptions

DAYS 12-16

5

Launch cart recovery

DAYS 17-21

6

Create post-purchase flows

DAYS 22-26

7

Review channel profitability

DAYS 27-30



MAKE IT CONCRETE

One-page system brief

Complete this before selecting tools or building assets. Short, specific answers are more useful than broad ambition.

01 HERO CUSTOMER AND PROBLEM

02 CORE OFFER AND MARGIN

03 PRIMARY AND SUPPORTING CHANNELS

04 INVENTORY SOURCE OF TRUTH

05 FULFILLMENT PROMISE

06 RETENTION OPPORTUNITY



EVIDENCE OVER ACTIVITY

A practical scorecard

Choose a small set of measures that show customer value, operational quality, and sustainable adoption.

MEASURE	BASELINE	TARGET	CADENCE
Conversion rate			
Average order value			
Cart completion			
Fulfillment time			
Return rate			

REVIEW QUESTION

What changed, why did it change, and what will we do next?



READY TO MOVE FORWARD?

Final readiness check

A healthy launch has clarity, ownership, safeguards, measurement, and a defined next review.

- ☐ The desired business and customer outcome is specific.
- ☐ A named owner is accountable for the system.
- ☐ The normal workflow and important exceptions are documented.
- ☐ Data access, privacy, and security requirements are reviewed.
- ☐ Users have been trained in the real workflow.
- ☐ Success measures have baselines, targets, and owners.
- ☐ A rollback or recovery path exists where needed.
- ☐ The first improvement review is scheduled.

YOUR NEXT STEP FORWARD

Continue with E-Commerce Specialist.

See the guided learning path: upstride-three.vercel.app/academy/e-commerce

FREE GUIDE TO GUIDED PRACTICE

Ready to build the skill?

This playbook gives you the framework. The matching Upstride Academy program helps you apply it through structured lessons, practical projects, downloadable tools, and a capstone.

RECOMMENDED PROGRAM

E-Commerce Specialist

UPSTRIDE ACADEMY | PRACTICAL, PROJECT-BASED LEARNING

What the program helps you do

1

Plan coordinated stores and marketplaces

Plan coordinated stores and marketplaces through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

2

Improve conversion, fulfillment, and retention

Improve conversion, fulfillment, and retention through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

3

Build a complete e-commerce operating plan

Build a complete e-commerce operating plan through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

CHOOSE YOUR SUPPORT LEVEL

Basic | Pro | Mentored

Review current package details and availability on the course page before enrolling.

View the program and enroll

upstride-three.vercel.app/academy/e-commerce